

Analyzing Human Motion for Predicting Penalty Direction in Football

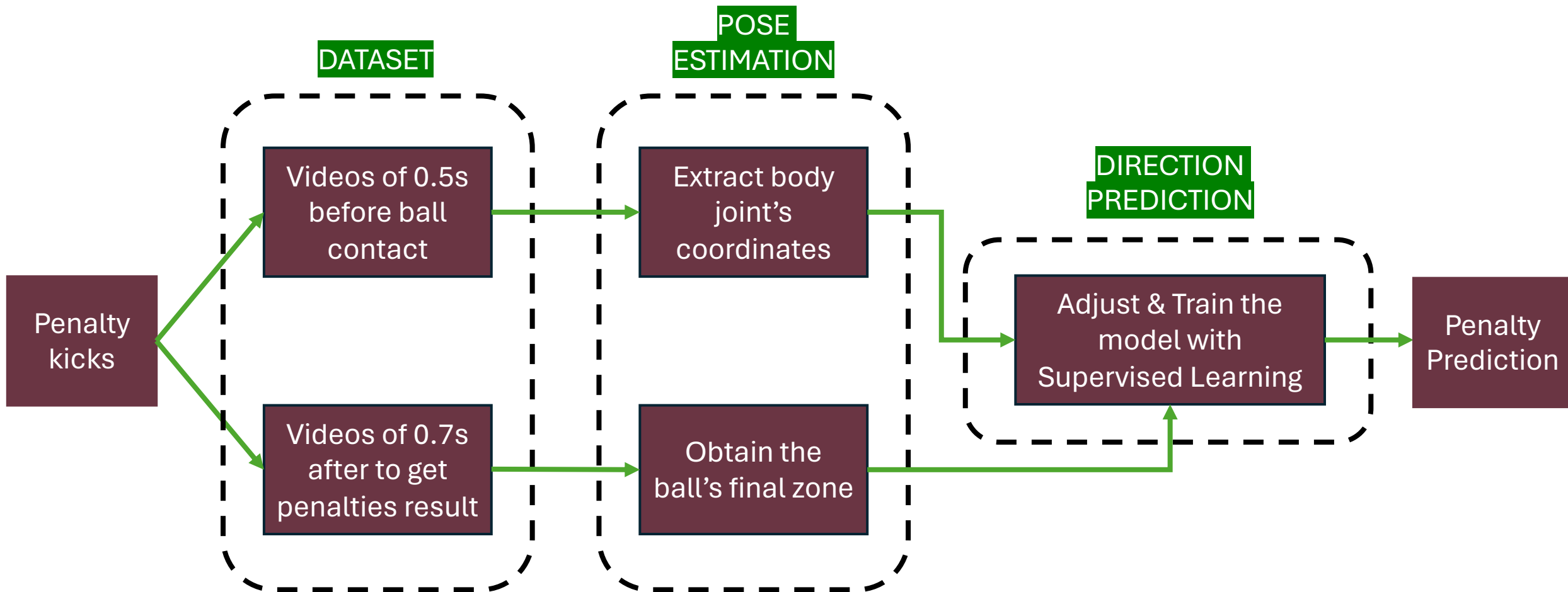
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- MA4 – Robotics
- Semester project of 8 ECTS
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A close-up photograph of a soccer ball with black and white hexagonal panels hitting a white goal net. The ball is positioned on the left side of the frame, and the net extends diagonally from the bottom left towards the top right. The background is a blurred green field.

Project

- **Dataset**
 - Made up of :
 - Penalty kick before ball contact
 - Penalty result
 - Large (min > 1'000 penalty kicks) → penalties from fifa games & automatic process.
- **Human body pose estimation**
 - Extract the body joints coordinates of the kicker
- **Train a transformer-based model with supervised learning**
 - Predict the direction of penalty kicks.



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Previous work

- **Master Thesis project from June 2023 in KU Leuven (found in a Github repository)**
 - Penalty kick Analysis: Visual Recognition, Pose Estimation and LSTM.
- **Dataset made of actual penalties in Youtube**
- **Yolov7 for ball/player detection**
- **LSTM prediction**
- **Limitations**
 - Manual selection of penalties
 - small dataset (792 videos)
 - 3 zones
 - Left, Center & Right
 - Increase from 33.8% to 41.6%
 - improvement of only 7.8%

A close-up photograph of a black and white soccer ball hitting a white goal net. The ball is positioned on the left side of the frame, and the net is on the right. The background is a blurred green field.

What I have I done

- **Dataset**

- Apply detection (Yolov9) on the ball to obtain :
 - Penalty kick before ball contact, 0.5s videos ~ 30 frames.
 - Result of the penalty in 6 zones, with a kalman filter on the ball.
- Processed 20 videos ~ 1'200 penalty kicks.
- Difficulties encountered :
 - Multiple outliers
 - Poor detection of the ball due to noisy background

- **Human body pose estimation**

- Start to apply a pre-trained model from OpenPifPaf to obtain the player's body joints coordinates.





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What's next

- **Complete extraction of body joints coordinates**
 - Pre-trained model “*shufflenetv2k30*” from OpenPifPaf.
- **Adjust the existing model to obtain the correct output**
 - ST-Trans (UnPOSeD github repository).
- **Train the model with supervised learning**
 - Feed the model with body joints coordinates from penalties videos.
 - Supervised learning with penalties result.

